

KENTARO VADNEY

K-12 Substitute Teacher | STEAM & Student Support

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Caring K-12 substitute instructor with hands-on classroom and childcare experience. Six months of STEAM substitute teaching with Whizara Academy plus one year of full-time nannying, building routines that support social-emotional skills, homework completion, and clear parent communication. Brings a strong tech background from software engineering roles—comfortable with devices, coding tools, and digital classrooms—while focusing on safe, inclusive, on-task learning.

CORE SKILLS

Classroom & Youth Support: Classroom management, positive behavior supports, differentiation, small-group facilitation, SEL-focused routines

Planning & Communication: Rapid lesson adaptation, clear directions, parent updates, progress notes, collaboration with lead teachers

Instruction & STEAM: Intro coding (block-based & Python basics), robotics concepts, project-based learning, hands-on demonstrations

Classroom Operations: Attendance and safety checks, transitions, materials setup, device troubleshooting, flexible scheduling

EXPERIENCE

Substitute Instructor, STEAM (K-8) • Whizara Academy — 6 months • San Francisco, CA (In-Person)

- Delivered substitute lessons in coding, robotics, and general STEAM topics for K-8 classes, following provided curricula and adapting pacing to student readiness
- Maintained orderly, inclusive virtual classrooms by setting expectations early, using positive reinforcement, and providing clear, concise directions
- Monitored engagement in real time, offering quick reteach and small-group support to keep students on task and confident with new tools

Full-Time Nanny • Private Family — 2022 • Alameda, CA

- Supported school-aged children with homework routines, reading practice, and age-appropriate math activities while maintaining consistent schedules
- Created daily plans with indoor/outdoor activities that encouraged curiosity, cooperation, and social-emotional skills
- Kept parents informed on daily progress and any concerns, ensuring alignment on expectations, safety, and student needs

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (SELECTED)

AI Trainer • Mercor — Dec 2025 – Present • Remote

- Builds high-quality training data and structured lesson-like tasks for AI systems; sharp digital literacy for classroom tech

Full Stack Software Engineer • Centigrade — Apr 2025 – Aug 2025 • Santa Clara, CA

- Led Python/FastAPI projects and taught teammates core concepts—experience translating complex ideas into clear, actionable steps

R&D Software Engineer • Belden — Jul 2023 – May 2024 • San Jose, CA

- Developed and explained technical solutions for cross-functional teams, reinforcing patience, clarity, and structured problem-solving

Distributed Systems Researcher • UC Berkeley RISE Lab — Aug 2021 – Dec 2021 • Berkeley, CA

- Led small research team on consensus protocols; honed skills in guiding groups, simplifying complex topics, and documenting results

EDUCATION

B.A., Computer Science • University of California, Berkeley

- Regents' and Chancellor's Scholar (top 1% merit scholarship)